大恶臭逼出了下水道

The Stink That Built London's Sewers



下水道本为消除臭味，为什么还能减少疾病?

READ 纯净阅读

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LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In the fierce heat of summer 1858, the curtains of the new Houses of Parliament hung heavy with chloride of lime, a bleach to make the air tolerable. The Thames festered, and MPs contemplated moving out.

The river had become London's lavatory. Antiquated sewers and outlets discharged the untreated sewage of some three million city dwellers into its currents, where the excrement stewed and decayed. The vile fumes grew so overpowering that the episode earned a name, the Great Stink.

Disgust found a voice on 15 July, when the Chancellor of the Exchequer, Benjamin Disraeli, denounced the river as a hellish pool of unbearable horrors. A bill funding new sewers was fast-tracked into law in about 18 days.

The engineer Joseph Bazalgette masterminded the response. His 82 miles of stout intercepting sewers caught the flow short of the river and diverted it east, downstream of the city. With some 1,100 miles of street sewers as tributaries, the infrastructure took 318 million bricks. Having calculated an adequate calibre for each pipe, he doubled it. The backbone lies buried underneath the newly built Victoria, Albert, and Chelsea Embankments. Substantially complete by 1875, much of the network is in use today.

Yet that sanitation rested on a fallacy. The predominant belief, miasma, blamed disease on foul air and vapours, so the sewers were intended principally to suppress the smell. They worked for an unintended reason, guarding the purity of the water Londoners drank.

Cholera resurfaced in 1866 and killed about 5,600 people in the East End, the one locality not yet connected.

A remedy aimed at the nose protected the gut.

中文译文

1858年夏天酷热难耐。新议会大厦的窗帘浸了含氯漂白粉，沉甸甸地垂着，只为让空气勉强可以忍受。泰晤士河腐败发臭，议员们考虑搬离。

这条河已成伦敦的厕所。老旧下水道和排污口，把约300万市民未经处理的污水排进河中，粪便在暑热中沤积、腐烂。恶臭强烈得令人无法忍受，这场事件因此有了一个名字：“大恶臭”。

7月15日，财政大臣本杰明·迪斯雷利替这份厌恶发了声，公开斥责河流是一潭地狱般、恐怖得让人无法忍受的污水。为新下水道拨款的法案加速审议，约18天便成为法律。

工程师约瑟夫·巴泽尔杰特主持设计这套应对工程。82英里坚固的截流下水道，在污水流入河中之前将其截住，改道向东，送往城市下游。约1100英里的街道下水道汇入这套系统，整项基础设施用了3.18亿块砖。他算出各条管道所需的内径后，又将直径加倍。系统主干埋在当时新建的维多利亚、阿尔伯特和切尔西河堤之下。管网到1875年基本建成，大部分至今仍在使用。

然而，这项公共卫生工程建立在一个错误观念之上。当时占主导的“瘴气说”把疾病归因于污浊空气与蒸气，因此修下水道主要是为了压住臭味。它们却因另一个并非设计初衷的原因而奏效：保护了伦敦人的饮用水水质。

1866年霍乱再次出现，在伦敦东区夺走约5600条生命；那里正是唯一尚未接入管网的地区。

原本冲着鼻子去的补救措施，保护的却是肠胃。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

tolerable adj.
可忍受的
to make the air tolerable

antiquated adj.
陈旧过时的
Antiquated sewers and outlets

discharge v.
排放
discharged the untreated sewage

untreated adj.
未经处理的
the untreated sewage

sewage n.
污水
the untreated sewage

denounce v.
公开斥责
denounced the river

bill n.
法案
A bill funding new sewers

fast-track v.
加速办理；加快审议
fast-tracked into law

mastermind v.
主持策划
masterminded the response

intercepting sewer 名词短语
截流下水道
stout intercepting sewers

divert v.
使改道
diverted it east

infrastructure n.
基础设施
the infrastructure took

adequate adj.
足够的
an adequate calibre

calibre n.
管道内径
an adequate calibre for each pipe

sanitation n.
公共卫生设施
that sanitation rested on a fallacy

fallacy n.
错误观念；谬误
rested on a fallacy

predominant adj.
占主导的
The predominant belief

suppress v.
压制；消除
to suppress the smell

unintended adj.
非本意的；未预期的
an unintended reason

purity n.
洁净
the purity of the water

resurface v.
再次出现
Cholera resurfaced in 1866

aim at 动词短语
针对；旨在改善
A remedy aimed at the nose

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共42项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

fierce heat 名词短语
酷热

Houses of Parliament 专名
英国议会大厦

lime n.
石灰；文中为含氯漂白剂成分

bleach n.
漂白剂

fester v.
腐败发臭

contemplate v.
考虑

lavatory n.
厕所

outlet n.
排污口

dweller n.
居民

current n.
水流

excrement n.
粪便

stew v.
在闷热中沤积

decay v.
腐败；腐烂

vile adj.
恶心的；恶劣的

fume n.
难闻的气体

overpowering adj.
强烈得难以忍受的

episode n.
事件；一段经历

stink n.
恶臭

disgust n.
厌恶

Chancellor of the Exchequer 专名
英国财政大臣

as prep.
是；引出斥责中的定性

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共42项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

hellish adj.
地狱般的

unbearable adj.
难以忍受的

stout adj.
坚固的

short of 介词短语
在到达……之前

downstream adv.
向下游

tributary n.
支流；汇入主干的支管

brick n.
砖块

double v.
使加倍

backbone n.
主干

bury v.
埋在地下

underneath prep.
在……下面

newly adv.
新近地

substantially adv.
基本上；大体上

in use 介词短语
在使用中

rest on 动词短语
建立在……之上

belief n.
观念；看法

foul air 名词短语
污浊空气

vapour n.
蒸气

principally adv.
主要地

locality n.
地区

gut n.
肠胃

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 The engineer Joseph Bazalgette _____ the response.

02 Having calculated an adequate calibre for each pipe, he _____ it.

03 Yet that sanitation rested on a _____.

04 A remedy _____ the nose protected the gut.

文章主线

- 危机 1858年酷暑，伦敦未经处理的污水在泰晤士河发臭，恶臭逼得议员考虑搬离议会。
- 行动 财政大臣公开抨击后，为新下水道拨款的法案约18天获通过，工程师巴泽尔杰特主持建设。
- 工程 82英里截流管拦下原本入河的污水，改送城市下游；按需要算出的管径再加倍。
- 误判 修下水道本为消除人们误认为会致病的臭气；实际作用是减少饮用水遭污水污染。
- 对照 1866年，唯一尚未接网的东区有约5600人死于霍乱；管网1875年基本完工，多数设施至今仍用。

参考答案　1 masterminded 2 doubled 3 fallacy 4 aimed at